

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**

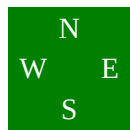
Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Board 2

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 6
♥ K 6 2
♦ J 10 8 3
♣ 9 8 5

♠ A 9 7 4 2
♥ A 9 8 3
♦ K 6
♣ Q 7



♠ 10 5 3
♥ Q 5 4
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ 10 4 3

♠ K 8
♥ J 10 7
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A K J 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♦ ¹
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
1. 4th suit			

North opens 1 ♠ - how do you respond? With 13 points, you respond 2 ♣, a natural 2/1 force to game. North next bids 2 ♥, showing the other Major suit. What do you rebid now? You assume North to be 5-4 in the Majors, so you cannot support either. You cannot bid 2NT without a stopper in ♦ s. So you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♦, telling North you know you must make a bid, but can't find anything appropriate. This is an artificial bid, and normally denies a diamond stopper (otherwise you would have bid 2NT). North rebids 3NT - what do you do now?

North now must find a bid. His choices include rebidding the 5-card ♠ s, supporting South's ♣ s with a doubleton Queen, or bidding 3NT with the ♦ K 6 as a stopper. He chooses this last option. It appears that 3NT is the best game for these two hands.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 7 6 3
 ♥ A Q 7
 ♦ J 4
 ♣ A Q J

♠ Q 5

♥ 4 2

♦ A 9 6 3 2

♣ 10 9 6 3



♠ A 4

♥ K J 10 8 6 5 3

♦ K Q

♣ 8 7

♠ 10 9 8 2

♥ 9

♦ 10 8 7 5

♣ K 5 4 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠ ¹	Pass
4 ♣ ²	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♠ ³	Pass	6 ♥	

All Pass

1. control

2. control

3. 2 keycards + trump Q

How do you open the bidding? With 18 HCP and a balanced hand, you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What do you rebid? You know this is a 5-card suit, and bid 3 ♥, confirming the 8+card trump fit and sets the trump suit. Partner rebids 3 ♠, a control bid, showing first or second round control. (Some will play this as showing 3-card support for spades, but I recommend playing this as a control bid.). You bid 4C, also a control bid, showing first or second round control in clubs. Partner bids 4NT, a keycard request using 1430.

You bid 5 ♠, showing two keycards and the trump queen. Partner bids the slam. The slam is a good one. If either the ♠Q or ♣K is right there are 12 tricks by way of a finesse. But the best way to play the hand would be to try to establish a ♠ in the West hand, and if that fails try the ♣ finesse.